

US-Iran Conflict Briefing

2020-10-02 · Evening edition · Issued 20:00 CDT

Sixth Tanker Strike Hits Kuwaiti VLCC in Hormuz

- The UK Maritime Trade Operations office said a tanker was struck by an unknown projectile while transiting the Strait of Hormuz on Thursday, sparking a fire on board; the crew was reported safe while the extent of damage and any environmental impact were still being assessed. — [Wall Street Journal](#)
- Maritime security firm Vanguard Tech identified the vessel as the Kuwait-flagged very large crude carrier Kazimah III, owned by the Kuwait Oil Tanker Company — the second KOTC supertanker hit in four days after the Al Funtas on September 28; UKMTO later reported the fire was small and extinguished, the ship is underway with no casualties and no environmental impact, and no group or state has claimed responsibility. — [Wall Street Journal](#)
- The strike extends a week of attacks on commercial shipping that maritime security tallies now put at six reported tanker strikes in the strait, and it came as Iran's 45-day ultimatum demanding the United States lift its naval blockade expired on October 1, with Iran's Supreme National Security Council saying it is determined to enforce control over the waterway and President Trump saying he will not let Iran blackmail the United States. — [Wall Street Journal](#)

FlyDubai Attack Called Terrorism as Iran-Link Evidence Disputed

- The United Arab Emirates' senior foreign-policy figure Anwar Gargash and Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu described the attack aboard FlyDubai Flight 1073 as terrorism on Friday; Netanyahu said the co-pilot was Omani and had undergone Islamist radicalization, that Israel has launched an investigation into who was behind the attack, and promised retribution. — [Wall Street Journal](#)
- An Emirati security team escorted the wounded captain, Smit Machchhar, and the co-pilot back to the United Arab Emirates from Saudi Arabia on Thursday; Reuters reported Israeli officials are expected to question the co-pilot as Israeli investigators join the UAE-led probe into the motive, background, and whether the incident involved terrorist direction or prior planning. — [Reuters](#)
- President Trump said Thursday that Iran may have been behind the co-pilot and would be struck very hard if so — but U.S. officials said the same day there was still no concrete evidence about who, if anyone, was behind it, no other involved country has blamed Iran, and Netanyahu himself has said it is too early to confirm Iranian involvement. — [Wall Street Journal](#)

Third Carrier Group Confirmed; Trump Eyes Post-Midterm Strikes

- The Pentagon is sending a third aircraft-carrier strike group and an additional Marine expeditionary unit to the Middle East, U.S. officials told the Wall Street Journal, adding 9,000 to 10,000 troops by the end of November; the USS Theodore Roosevelt left San Diego on Sunday and the USS Makin Island amphibious group with the 13th Marine Expeditionary Unit left Monday. — [Wall Street Journal](#)
- Trump recently told aides he expects to resume bombing Iran in November, the Journal reported, and said in a Time magazine interview published Thursday that increasing strikes after the November 3 midterm elections is possible if no deal with Tehran is reached. — [Wall Street Journal](#)

- The buildup would put three U.S. carrier strike groups in the region for the first time since April, joining the USS George H.W. Bush and USS George Washington already there plus the Boxer amphibious group — adding to more than 50,000 U.S. troops already in the region. — [Wall Street Journal](#)

Fairford Probe: Proxy Claims and an Israeli Intel Twist

- Wall Street Journal reporting says investigators are exploring whether Iran used potentially unwitting criminal proxies in the foiled RAF Fairford plot, with a branch of Iran's Revolutionary Guard said to have recruited UK nationals for a multi-step operation; Iran has a record of hiring criminal proxies on European soil, often via encrypted apps. — [Wall Street Journal](#)
- Netanyahu told Fox News that Israel gave British authorities intelligence about an Iranian-sponsored attack on RAF Fairford before it happened. — [The Times](#)
- Prime Minister Andy Burnham says there are strong indications Iran played a part; Iran's embassy in London categorically rejects the claim, and counterterrorism police say they are examining all angles including foreign state involvement. — [Wall Street Journal](#)

Markets

- Brent crude settled at \$102.70 a barrel on October 2, up from the morning's \$99.79 intraday quote, after European leaders agreed to President Trump's request to release diesel reserves; the G7 announced a coordinated 100-million-barrel release over four months with a frontloaded diesel release in the first 20 days. — [Reuters](#)
- U.S. West Texas Intermediate settled at \$91.26 a barrel on October 2, down on the day as the reserve-release news weighed, but up from the morning's \$89.36 intraday quote. — [Reuters](#)

Related media

A tanker burns in the Strait of Hormuz after an earlier strike this year — the Kuwaiti VLCC Kazimah III was hit Thursday, the week's sixth reported tanker attack. — [view original](#)



A U.S. Navy carrier at sea — the USS Theodore Roosevelt strike group is deploying to the Middle East, which would put three U.S. carrier groups in the region. — [view original](#)



A FlyDubai jet — the FZ1073 co-pilot was returned to the UAE on Thursday as Israeli investigators join the probe into the cockpit attack. — [view original](#)

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